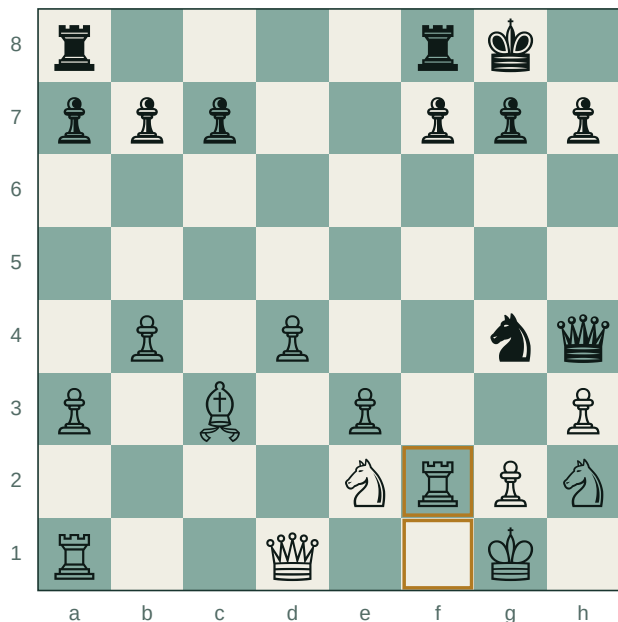


Kingside attacks: Black, move 18

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 18.Rxf2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18...Qxf2+ 19. Kh1 Nxe3 20. Qg1 Qxe2

18...Qxf2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f2 it attacks king on g1 and knight on e2. Recorded reply: **19.Kh1**.

19...Nxe3 The knight captures the pawn on e3. Recorded reply: **20.Qg1**.

20...Qxe2 The queen captures the knight on e2.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -6 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.